

Recreation and Healthy Active Living Leadership, Grade 12

University/College Preparation

PLF4M

This course enables students to explore the benefits of lifelong participation in active recreation and healthy leisure and to develop the leadership and coordinating skills needed to plan, organize, and safely implement recreational events and other activities related to healthy, active living. Students will also learn how to promote the benefits of healthy, active living to others through mentoring and assisting them in making informed decisions that enhance their well-being. The course will prepare students for university programs in physical education and health and kinesiology and for college and university programs in recreation and leisure management, fitness and health promotion, and fitness leadership.

Prerequisite: Any health and physical education course

A. LEADERSHIP

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.** demonstrate an understanding of the concept of leadership and of the attributes, skills, and styles needed to be an effective leader;
- A2.** demonstrate leadership skills in a variety of contexts related to healthy, active living;
- A3.** demonstrate an understanding of group dynamics, and apply teamwork skills in a variety of contexts related to healthy, active living.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Leadership Styles

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** demonstrate an understanding of the concept of leadership, and compare various leadership styles and their use in a variety of situations (*e.g., using an empathetic style when the goal is to help others; using a transformational style when the goal is to create change; using an assertive or autocratic style in an emergency situation; using a democratic style to increase input, build consensus, and facilitate decision making; using a laissez-faire style when the participants understand the task and have the skills to be successful*)

Teacher prompt: “What do we mean by leadership? What does a leader do? There are many possible answers to these questions. That’s because many different kinds of people in our society can be leaders, and people can be leaders in different ways. Leaders also don’t have to be individuals. They can be groups. But all these different kinds of leadership have certain things in common, which is why we recognize them as leadership. Essentially, they are about one person or a group influencing others to work together to achieve a goal.”

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Teacher prompt: “The way in which people lead often depends on the context in which they are leading. Military leaders rely heavily, but not entirely, on an autocratic style. That’s partly because military organizations are very hierarchical and have a strong sense of tradition. It’s also because military leaders have to retain control and coordinate the activities of people in chaotic and dangerous situations. First Nation, Métis, and Inuit leaders tend to use a style that reflects an emphasis on spirituality and consensus. Leadership is seen as a responsibility to the community and not a way of achieving personal importance. A person who chairs a committee may use a democratic style in order to allow committee members who represent different interests and points of view and may have different kinds of expertise to reach an agreement that is acceptable to all or most of its members.

“Think of some of the different kinds of leadership positions that exist in our society and community today – for example, a police or fire chief, a political leader, a director of a daycare, a religious or spiritual leader, a business leader, or a leader of an environmental group. Within these different roles, which style or styles do these leaders tend to use, and why?”

- A1.2** identify the attributes and skills needed to be an effective leader (*e.g., personal attributes, such as integrity and empathy, self-knowledge, a sense of responsibility for one's own actions and learning, confidence and assertiveness; interpersonal skills, such as the ability to build commitment, empower others, recognize contributions and individual differences, build harmonious relationships; critical and creative thinking skills, such as the ability to evaluate past performance and determine what could have been done differently, to transfer learning to new situations, to plan ahead*) through analysis of the characteristics of effective leaders, including Canadian leaders in physical activity, recreation, and sport, and use this information as a basis for assessing their own leadership attributes and skills

Teacher prompt: “Is a leader born or made? How is a leader different from a manager? What are the personal attributes and skills that make someone an effective leader? Do you need all of them to be a leader? Think of a few people who exhibit great leadership qualities. What do they have in common? How are they different? What are the leadership skills that these people have that you would like to develop?”

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Teacher prompt: “Leadership can come from groups of people. In 2000, for example, Indigenous leaders and federal and provincial government representatives met in Alberta to affirm their commitment to improving the health, wellness, and quality of life of First Nation, Métis, and Inuit peoples through physical education, sport, and recreation. The meeting produced the Maskwachees Declaration, which identified the challenges these communities faced in achieving these goals and also the strengths that could support their efforts to achieve them. Can you think of other examples of leadership by a group of people and describe the attributes or skills that individuals in the group needed to make the group's leadership effective?”

- A1.3** demonstrate the ability (*e.g., through role play or simulation, case study analysis, leading a class activity such as a warm-up*) to select and apply the most appropriate leadership styles for achieving a specific objective in a variety of contexts related to healthy, active living (*e.g., using an assertive or autocratic style when teaching safety procedures for an activity; using a transformational style when encouraging the personal growth of group members in order to enhance group effectiveness; using an empathetic style when the goal is to meet needs within the group, such as resolving personal difficulties; using a democratic style when consensus is important, as in reaching agreement on a set of rules for a low organizational game or when working with classmates to decide on activities for a spirit day*)

Teacher prompt: “Although we have talked about many different leadership styles, it's important to recognize that leadership is not a black and white concept with set categories and static criteria. To be effective, leaders need to be flexible. Different situations may require different leadership styles or the use of more than one approach. Thus, while leaders may favour a certain style, they often use a blend of approaches. What leadership approaches would you use when organizing a class event, and why?”

Student: “My leadership approaches would depend on the situation and on the abilities and skills that I and other members of the group have. I would consider what my classmates want to do and what we want to achieve through the activity. Knowing that, I can then determine my role in the group and the roles of my classmates. Involving them in planning and making decisions increases my chances of success. By getting to know them better I can see what abilities and skills everyone has to contribute to the success of the activity.”

A2. Leadership Skills

By the end of this course, students will:

A2.1 demonstrate the ability to use communication skills (e.g., *expressing ideas, listening and responding to others, and interpreting information effectively; recognizing and understanding non-verbal signals and body language*) to develop healthy relationships and provide direction to participants involved in a variety of activities related to healthy, active living

A2.2 demonstrate the ability to use interpersonal skills (e.g., *active listening, negotiating skills, assertiveness skills*) and conflict resolution strategies (e.g., *approaching the conflict with a positive attitude; focusing on the problem, not the person; listening to all opinions before making judgements; demonstrating sensitivity to diverse individual needs*) to minimize and resolve conflicts when interacting with others

A2.3 demonstrate the ability to make decisions, set goals, and solve problems when in a leadership role, taking into consideration the viewpoints of oneself and others and the availability of resources (e.g., *make decisions about rule and equipment modifications to accommodate various levels of ability; set realistic goals, such as ensuring that every participant has an opportunity to be engaged and be active during the activity; devise an alternative plan of action to solve a problem*)

Teacher prompt: “You are planning an outdoor event that will take place next month. What will you do if you are unable to hold the event outside because of the weather?”

Student: “We have a few choices. If we have not planned to proceed ‘rain or shine’, we can move the event indoors. We will have to check in advance to make sure that the facilities are available or can be shared with other groups that have already booked them. We may also have to make some changes to the activities we planned. An alternative plan would be to postpone the activity to another day, but because that would have to be done at short notice, we would have to have a way of notifying all the participants quickly, perhaps through a message on the school website. In either case, we have to have our alternative plan in place well before the event, and we have to make sure that all participants know about it.”

A2.4 demonstrate the ability to use adaptive, organizational, and time management skills to plan physical activities (e.g., *plan a warm-up for a creative movement or fitness class that will fit a specific time frame; organize a class into fair teams; organize the equipment necessary to run an activity; be flexible when confronting last-minute challenges such as having to share facilities, having to reorganize teams because of a decreased number of participants, or having only a limited amount of equipment available; modify an activity to meet the needs of a student who uses an assistive device*)

A2.5 demonstrate the ability to apply leadership skills within the context of activities related to healthy active living objectives (e.g., *organize a dance class, an intramural activity such as a swim meet or a cross-country run, an in-class tournament, an assembly to increase awareness about how to reduce gender-based violence, sexual harassment, homophobia, racism or other forms of prejudice, such as discrimination based on age, size, or abilities, in the school community; teach a new skill/game to another class; invent or adapt a recreational game and present it to children with special needs; coordinate the promotion of a health fair*)

A3. Group Dynamics and Teamwork

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 describe factors that affect the interaction of people within groups (*e.g., presence or absence of a shared vision, group size, established norms, stages of group development, diversity of the group, skills and experiences of group members, personal biases, emotional comfort of group environment*)

A3.2 describe strategies that can be used to facilitate group effectiveness (*e.g., setting group norms, establishing a shared vision and goals, establishing a conflict resolution process, building consensus so that decisions are supported by most or all members of the group, using a quality review process to evaluate and improve the quality of the group's product as it is developed, celebrating success*)

Teacher prompt: "To achieve any of your goals, it is very important to understand that you must first be able to work effectively as a group. What strategies would help you to build cohesiveness within the group and then maintain your effectiveness as a group?"

Students: "Since we are from a variety of different home situations and backgrounds, we may have different expectations and experiences of how a group should function and how decisions should be made. I think we have to begin by considering what our purpose and goals are as a group so that we can move towards a shared vision. Establishing a shared vision will help to bring us together as a group, as we will then have at least one thing to unite us." "We need to create group norms or rules about how we will work together, such as agreeing to keep all members fully involved in the group's activities so that we each feel valued, to use respectful language to avoid unnecessary conflict, and to stay focused on the task so that we can do our best work." "We need to set up processes for making decisions as a group and resolving any conflicts that might arise. For instance, I think it will be more effective if all of us take part in resolving a conflict and take responsibility for whatever role we played in it. This will help all of us feel safer and more valued in the group and will give the group greater harmony and cohesion."

A3.3 describe individual behaviours and attitudes that contribute to effective teamwork and group success (*e.g., assuming roles, such as summarizer, task initiator, encourager, that enhance group cohesion and effectiveness; demonstrating commitment to the group process by abiding by group norms and processes, taking responsibility for carrying out tasks assigned by the group, sharing knowledge and expertise, building on the ideas of others; maintaining the cohesiveness of the group by working collaboratively, appreciating differences in people, being respectful of individuals and their contributions to the task*)

Teacher prompt: "Conflicts sometimes occur, even in very cohesive and effective groups. Group members may have different perspectives that reflect differences in their backgrounds, and their views may diverge over time. Sometimes conflict can be beneficial and lead to better decisions – opposing views can generate deeper thinking on issues – but conflict can also result because some members become obstructive and hinder the work of the group. How can we ensure that conflict within the group remains constructive, and how can we deal with obstructive behaviour and reinforce the group's effectiveness and cohesion?"

Students: "For conflict to be constructive, members of the group must be willing to respect and understand views that are different from their own. Individuals must feel safe to voice what they think." "On the other hand, behaviour that takes the form of dominating discussions, verbally attacking other group members, or distracting the group with trivial information is unproductive and needs to be addressed. Group members need to intervene and re-establish the norms and processes that the group has developed and agreed to. Using the negotiation and mediation skills that we've learned should help resolve these types of conflicts."

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Teacher prompt: “Everyone brings different abilities and skills to any team. When working as part of a team, each member takes responsibility for his or her share of the work to achieve the goals of the group. Why is this important to the success of a team? How can individuals contribute to a team’s effectiveness?”

Student: “The overall effectiveness of a team depends on how well and how reliably each member performs his or her share of the work. Apart from doing our own work well, we can contribute to the team’s effectiveness by sharing information, resources, and expertise and by giving positive feedback and encouragement to other team members.”

- A3.4** demonstrate the ability (*e.g., through simulations, initiative games, and problem-solving exercises; by organizing and running a tournament for the class*) to use a variety of strategies and teamwork skills to facilitate group effectiveness in achieving goals related to healthy, active living

B. FACILITATION OF RECREATION AND LEISURE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.** identify and explain the benefits of lifelong participation in active recreation and healthy leisure, and demonstrate an understanding of factors that enable and constrain participation in active recreation and healthy leisure activities;
- B2.** demonstrate the ability to plan and coordinate an event related to healthy, active living;
- B3.** demonstrate an understanding of safety procedures needed for injury prevention in a variety of activities related to healthy, active living.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Promotion of Lifelong Participation

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** explain the terms *active recreation* and *healthy leisure*, and describe the potential social, economic, and environmental benefits that active recreation and healthy leisure can provide for a community (e.g., **social:** *enhancement of family and other social bonds, promotion of empathy and equity, reduction of isolation and alienation through participation in shared activities*; **economic:** *employment, reduction of health care costs and productivity losses*; **environmental:** *reduction of carbon emissions and emissions of other air pollutants through use of active transportation*)

Teacher prompt: “Active recreation pursuits and healthy leisure pursuits are of great benefit to both individuals and the entire community. How are active recreation and healthy leisure pursuits similar to each other, and what is the fundamental difference between them? How does each type of pursuit contribute to healthy living?”

Students: “Leisure is defined as our free time. Recreation is what we do during our free time for relaxation and enjoyment. Active recreation involves physical activities such as walking, biking, and sports, and healthy leisure involves any non-physical leisure activities that promote our personal health. For example, reading, listening to music, and socializing are all healthy leisure activities because they can be relaxing, but they can’t be considered active recreation.” “Both active recreation and healthy leisure are important components of a balanced life, and both contribute to mental health, relaxation, and stress reduction. Because it involves physical activity, active recreation also provides important physical health benefits.”

Teacher: “Active recreation and healthy leisure contribute to healthy communities. What can communities do to encourage active recreation and healthy leisure?”

Student: “Communities can provide facilities, such as parks, libraries, playgrounds, and pools, that encourage active recreation and healthy leisure. By considering active recreation initiatives, such as extending the amount of green space, for example, communities can increase opportunities for outdoor recreation and leisure and also benefit the environment.”

- B1.2** explain why lifelong participation in active recreation and healthy leisure is an important contributor to one's quality of life and well-being (*e.g., improves and maintains personal health-related fitness; helps prevent or manage chronic disease; has a positive influence on mental health; creates time for family bonding; improves social networking and creates opportunities for developing and strengthening personal relationships*)

Teacher prompt: "Participating in active recreation and healthy leisure is extremely important if you want to maintain a good quality of life, but some people find that their overall activity levels decline as they get older. Why is it important for people to remain involved in a variety of activities at each stage of their lives?"

Student: "Participation in active recreation and healthy leisure helps balance the everyday stresses in life and can be a good coping mechanism when stress is really high. It can also help people cope with illness, because it may help them feel that they have some control over their own bodies. To have a good quality of life, you need to have a balance among work, family, and your own interests. Being involved in active recreation or healthy leisure activities that you like helps to maintain that balance."

- B1.3** describe motivational factors (*e.g., physical health benefits, stress management benefits, enjoyment, opportunities for learning new skills, social interaction*) and potential challenges (*e.g., financial constraints; lack of programs; lack of facilities or poor access to facilities; transportation difficulties; restrictions related to family values, social, or cultural norms; language barriers; low level of fitness; poor environmental conditions*) that affect lifelong participation in active recreation and healthy leisure, and identify strategies for overcoming these challenges (*e.g., overcome financial and time constraints by identifying inexpensive and convenient recreational resources within the community, such as community education or recreation programs and worksite programs, or by planning social activities that involve physical activity*)

Teacher prompt: "What encourages you to participate in active recreation, and what helps to keep you involved?"

Student: "Fitness is important for me, but coming from an Anishnaabe background, I am also interested in activities that relate to my culture. Along with some other girls, I recently learned the art of hoop dancing and the life teachings that accompany the dance. It combines physical conditioning with the artistry and traditions of our culture. The hoops represent unity, and the various formations symbolize the interconnectedness of all the races of humankind and all of creation. Participating in hoop dancing gives me feelings of satisfaction and confidence."

- B1.4** demonstrate an understanding of promotional strategies that are sensitive to the diversity of the community, and apply them to communicate the benefits of lifelong participation in active recreation and healthy leisure

Teacher prompt: "What promotional strategies could be used to encourage students from diverse backgrounds to participate in active recreation and healthy leisure activities?"

Student: "When planning and promoting opportunities for physical activity, we always need to keep the interests of all audiences in mind. Making sure that a wide mix of students is involved in the planning can help to make sure that the activities that are promoted appeal to students from a variety of social and cultural backgrounds."

B2. Event Planning and Coordination

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** demonstrate the ability to use an assessment process (*e.g., survey, interview, interest checklist, committee brainstorming session*) to gather information about the characteristics and requirements of a target group before organizing an event (*e.g., size of the group; age, sex, diversity, skills, abilities, and interests of the participants*)

Teacher prompt: “One suggestion for reducing harassment within the school is to provide opportunities for students to be involved in physical activities during lunch and after school. Before we can plan the activities, we will need to find out more about the interests and skill levels of the students. How can we get this information?”

Students: “We could create survey questions and get the teachers to distribute them a few days before we want to collect the information, so that the students will have a chance to read them and think about what they want. But first we need to brainstorm as a group to determine what information we actually need from them in order to create the survey questions.” “The survey could include questions that ask the students to describe the types of physical activities they enjoy. Do they like activities that come from other parts of the world? Do they prefer team or individual activities, indoor or outdoor settings? Which day of the week is best for them? What skill level do they prefer? And so on. After a couple of days we could visit each class and talk to the students. If they have a list of suggestions, we could review it with them. If not, then we could create one with them. We could also complete the survey with them during the class visit. That way we would be sure to get the information we need.”

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- B2.2** demonstrate the ability to analyse the information gathered from the assessment process and incorporate the results into a plan for an event (e.g., *prioritize needs to make sure the event meets those that are most important; identify physical, personal, and financial resources needed; identify community partnerships that could facilitate access to resources; determine availability and accessibility of facilities and equipment and supervision requirements*)

Teacher prompt: “Consider the following: Are the assessment results consistent enough to use as a basis for your decisions? Have different interests and different skill levels and abilities been considered? Also, do you have enough facility space to do everything the participants might want to do? Will you have enough supervision and administrative support? How will this information affect your plan?”

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- B2.3** develop an action plan, using the results gathered from the assessment process, to run an event that promotes healthy, active living (e.g., *create an event committee and determine roles; establish goals; identify tasks to be completed; establish timelines; consider budget needs; consider strategies to minimize environmental impact; establish safety procedures; establish criteria for assessing the success of the event*)

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- B2.4** identify and apply strategies for effectively communicating information about an event to a target group (e.g., *poster advertising; targeted electronic communication, including social media; presentations to the target group*)

Teacher prompt: “The school is thinking of organizing a leave-your-car-at-home day to raise awareness of pollution from motor vehicles and to promote the benefits of the various forms of active transportation, like walking, biking, rollerblading, or skateboarding. What strategies will you use to promote the event and the benefits of active transportation?”

Students: “Different audiences require different approaches. Our most important audience is in the school – students, teachers, and staff. We can reach them by making public service announcements over the PA, distributing flyers to every classroom, and posting displays in the halls. We can also target groups outside the school. We can inform parents of the event and the reasons behind it by sending flyers home with students and posting information on the school website. We can target the public outside the school community by putting messages on the school sign, asking merchants to display our posters in their windows, and sending news releases to the local newspaper and radio stations.” “What we say to each target audience will depend on the media we use and on the particular interests and concerns of the different audiences. In all cases, however, the basic message will be the same: Use your car less and use active transportation more. It’s easier than you think, it’s good for the environment, and it’s good for your health.”

- B2.5** demonstrate the ability to implement an action plan to run a healthy active living event, evaluate its success on the basis of pre-established criteria, and make recommendations for improvements

Teacher prompt: “After celebrating the success of your event, it is important to reflect on how well you met the criteria that you established in your action plan. This reflection will help you determine what you did well and what you need to improve to make future events even more successful. What did you learn from your experience? In what way did you meet the criteria you established in your action plan, and what changes do you need to consider in order to achieve better results for your next event?”

Student: “The goals of the event met the needs of our target group, who wanted to improve their sending skills and learn some new games. It was also important for them to be in an environment where they felt comfortable enough to try new things, and the activities had to be fun. We accomplished all of these goals. Giving them time to practise their skills raised their comfort level, and we introduced two new games that they enjoyed. Since they were not well-known games, everyone was starting at the same point and no one had a skill advantage. We had no safety problems, and overall we were successful in meeting the needs of the target group. However, we did have scheduling challenges. We should have given more thought to how we would split the available time between practising new skills and actually playing games. Next time, I think we need to appoint a timekeeper to keep the event running smoothly. We also need to clarify our roles more frequently so we can make sure that all tasks get done as planned.”

B3. Safety and Injury Prevention

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** describe current guidelines, procedures, and contingency plans (*e.g., school board and provincial safety guidelines, procedures for obtaining informed consent, emergency action plans*) for ensuring the safety of participants in activities related to healthy, active living within their school community
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- B3.2** demonstrate the ability to apply procedures for preventing injuries in a variety of activities related to healthy, active living (*e.g., following the board’s risk management guidelines, using protective equipment, identifying hazards within the event area and bringing attention to them, following fire regulations*)
- Teacher prompt:** “When planning an event, we need to develop an emergency action plan that adheres to the board’s risk management guidelines and the school’s safety policies and procedures. What other steps can we take to avoid injuries during physical activity?”
- Student:** “We can also go through a safety checklist before beginning the activity. The checklist would include such questions as: Is there appropriate supervision in place or a qualified instructor to lead the activity? Have the activity area and equipment been inspected? Is there a fully stocked and readily available first-aid kit? Is the emergency action plan in place? Can students of all abilities participate safely?”
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- B3.3** demonstrate an understanding of skills needed by first responders (*e.g., qualified first-aid personnel, including those with cardiopulmonary resuscitation [CPR], emergency first aid, or aquatics certification and individuals trained in the use of an automated external defibrillator [AED]*) to respond to medical emergencies in a variety of physical activities

Teacher prompt: “When planning an event, you need to make sure that procedures are in place for ensuring the safety of both participants and spectators. Events should be overseen by qualified supervisors so that the risk of injury is minimized, but qualified first responders should also be available so that medical emergencies can be dealt with immediately. Think of some different events you might be involved in planning and the kinds of medical emergencies that might arise. What types of skills would first responders need to respond to those emergencies? Who would have those skills?”

C. MENTORING DEVELOPMENT

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.** demonstrate an understanding of mentorship and the methods used by effective mentors to contribute to the growth and development of others;
- C2.** demonstrate the ability to help others develop and implement a personal healthy active living plan.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Mentorship

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** describe the concept of mentorship, and identify the attributes of an effective mentor (*e.g., is a coach, a motivator, an effective communicator, and a role model; shares knowledge, skills, and expertise; provides guidance and effective feedback; empowers others*)

Teacher prompt: “What does the term *mentorship* mean, and what attributes are important to be an effective mentor?”

Student: “Mentorship is a relationship between two people in which one person has knowledge, skills, or experience that he or she is willing to share with the other person. An effective mentor is genuinely interested in people and willing to spend time helping others. An effective mentor should be able to build respectful relationships and have the ability to encourage and motivate others and help them gain confidence. For instance, I have a mentorship relationship with a younger student who is new to Canada, and I am helping him to adjust to his school and get involved with activities so he can meet friends. I sometimes encourage him to join intramural activities with me, and I help him learn the games. He asks me questions about all sorts of things, and I try to give him the best guidance I can or encourage him to talk to someone else who can help him. I also spend time with him to help him improve his reading and writing so he can be successful here. I can really see the change in his level of confidence and his language skills since I became his mentor, and he is starting to get involved in physical activities without me.”

- C1.2** explain how an effective mentor contributes to the growth and development of others (*e.g., establishes a relationship with others to build trust; motivates others to increase their own self-worth; coaches others to develop their skills and acquire an appreciation for learning; empowers others to make them feel valued and safe and willing to try new things*)

Teacher prompt: “When thinking about making a change in their lives and attempting something new, people are often apprehensive. Taking the first step involves a certain amount of risk, and they may not feel confident about their ability to succeed. What do you need to do as an effective mentor to help someone overcome a lack of confidence? How would you establish a trusting relationship with that person? What would you need to do to help the person you are coaching meet his or her goals?”

- C1.3** demonstrate the ability to use mentorship skills in a variety of contexts related to healthy, active living (e.g., *be a role model; share knowledge and expertise during physical activities; encourage others to try new activities by joining clubs, teams, or committees; encourage others to set goals or improve skills to enhance their personal well-being; provide meaningful feedback in a non-judgemental manner when coaching others toward their goals*)

C2. Healthy Active Living Plan

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** describe how healthier choices related to physical activity, healthy eating, and other aspects of everyday living (e.g., *limiting screen time and increasing participation in a variety of physical activities that provide cardiovascular and muscular endurance, muscular strength, or flexibility benefits; eating balanced meals; choosing nutritious snacks; managing stress; getting enough sleep; making choices with personal safety in mind*) contribute to better physical, mental, and social health and greater personal well-being

Teacher prompt: “Making healthier choices can affect your health in many ways, because health has many dimensions. What does social health mean? How do healthier choices contribute to better social health?”

Student: “Social health refers to your health and well-being in relation to your interactions with others directly and with the community as a whole. Being socially healthy includes knowing and understanding yourself and being able to use that knowledge to help you relate to others. On a community level, social health could be related to equity, inclusion, and the social structure of our communities and neighbourhoods. In a socially healthy community, people would have access to other people, groups, and organizations that provide support and opportunities for healthy interaction.”

- C2.2** demonstrate the ability to assist “clients” (e.g., *other students in the class or younger students in health and physical education classes scheduled during the same time block, fictitious clients*) in selecting and using a variety of appraisal methods and resources to assess personal physical activity levels, fitness, and eating patterns (e.g., *Physical Activity Readiness Questionnaire-Plus [Par-Q+]; Canadian Society for Exercise Physiology Physical Activity Training for Health [CSEP-PATH]; Canadian Physical Activity Guidelines; Start Stop Continue assessment technique; Canada’s Food Guide and Canada’s Food Guide – First Nations, Inuit and Métis; other health-related fitness appraisals; daily food and activity journals; software programs*)

Teacher prompt: “Some friends have asked you to advise them on making changes that will help them lead healthier, more active lives. For convenience, we’ll refer to them as your clients. What appraisal methods and resources might you advise your clients to use to assess their current physical activity levels, fitness, eating patterns, and overall health, and how would you help them use them?”

Student: “Even if my clients already want to improve their fitness, they will still need to use appropriate appraisal tools to determine what their current level of fitness actually is. We need to select health-related fitness assessments that are appropriate for their current levels of fitness and fitness goals and that they are comfortable doing. Once completed, these will give them information about their current cardiorespiratory fitness and their muscle strength, muscular endurance, and flexibility. The best results can be obtained by giving them a choice of two or three different assessments, and letting them choose which ones they want to do and in what order. They can then use these results to set goals related to increasing their involvement in physical activity. Before becoming more physically active and doing any of the fitness assessments, however, they should complete the Physical Activity Readiness Questionnaire to make sure they can safely begin to increase their activity levels. To assess their current eating patterns, they can use Canada’s Food Guide or Canada’s Food Guide – First Nations, Inuit and Métis.”

- C2.3** demonstrate the ability to assist “clients” in interpreting appraisal results and using the information to make changes in their daily lives that are related to physical activity, fitness, healthy eating, and other factors that affect overall health (*e.g., before analysing the results, reassure clients that their information will remain confidential; assist clients in identifying their needs and interests and understanding the multiple factors that influence their current health and activity practices as revealed by their assessment information; assist clients in using their assessment information to establish and prioritize fitness, physical activity, healthy eating, or broader health goals; support clients in setting achievable short-term goals to maintain participation*)

Teacher prompt: “Once your clients have completed their physical activity and nutritional assessments, you can help them interpret the results and set their goals. You could begin by introducing them to the Canadian Physical Activity Guidelines, the Canadian Sedentary Behaviour Guidelines, and Canada’s Food Guide and showing them how to use these guides when setting and managing goals. For example, comparing their activity level assessments with the recommendations in the physical activity and sedentary behaviour guidelines will help your clients determine some of the things they could do to improve their level of physical activity. Similarly, comparing their nutrition assessments with the recommendations in Canada’s Food Guide will help them identify affordable and relevant changes that they should make to their eating habits. This and the other health-related fitness information that you and your clients have collected will give your clients a range of options from which they can choose priorities, set realistic goals, and make the changes needed to achieve them.”

- C2.4** demonstrate the ability to assist “clients” in designing and following a personal healthy active living plan (*e.g., collaborate with clients to create individual plans; motivate clients to apply strategies that will help them achieve goals within their plans; encourage a commitment to action; provide specific feedback and praise on a regular basis; support clients in assessing progress and making revisions to their plans; celebrate their successes*)

Teacher prompt: “How do you help a client who would like to make several changes in his or her activity and eating habits but is having a difficult time getting started? How do you help a client who sets unrealistic goals or unrealistic timelines for achieving them and doesn’t understand why his or her plan is not sustainable? How do you help such a client set realistic goals?”

- C2.5** identify community resources and support services related to physical activity, healthy eating, and personal well-being (*e.g., public health units, credible and accurate websites, youth centres, recreation centres*)